

ReadingBuddy — Testing Guide

Round 5 · for Android, iOS, and Windows-based testers

Thanks for helping test! This guide walks you through everything the app should do, plus the new bits we recently added. The goal is to make sure the app still works the way it always has, and to catch anything weird in the new parts before kids see it.

You don't need to be a developer to do this. Just an iPad / iPhone or Android phone / tablet, an internet connection, and about 45–60 minutes.

If something feels off — even a tiny thing — please write it down (see “How to report problems” at the end). It's better to flag a non-issue than to miss a real one.

Before you start

What you need

- An Android device (Android 10 or newer) OR an iPad / iPhone (iOS 14 or newer). A tablet is preferred where you have a choice — that's the primary form factor for kids reading.
- The latest test build of ReadingBuddy installed on that device.
- Wi-Fi internet for most of the testing. One section asks you to briefly turn Wi-Fi off, so make sure you can do that.
- A way to take notes — a paper notebook, a Word doc on your Windows PC, a notes app on your phone, whatever's comfortable.
- Optional but helpful: the ability to take screenshots on the device when something looks wrong.

One-time setup

If you have a previous version of the app installed, please delete it first, then install the new test build. This makes sure we start with a clean slate (no leftover reading progress, no leftover cached images from earlier versions). You only need to do this once at the start.

After the first launch, the app will download about 30 MB of content over the first few minutes of use. That's normal — it's caching things so future launches are faster.

How to fill out this guide

Each step has a checkbox ☐ next to it. Mark it by replacing the box with one of:

☐ — works as described

☐ — doesn't work

☐ — kind of works but something feels off (slow, ugly, jumpy)

— — not applicable to your device

If you mark ☐ , ☐ or ☐ , jot a quick note about what you saw next to that line. The note doesn't need to be technical — “the cover was blurry for 2 seconds before it sharpened” is a perfectly good note.

1. First launch

After your fresh install, tap the ReadingBuddy icon.

- ☐ **1.1** App opens within about 5 seconds. You see a loading screen, then the main screen appears.
- ☐ **1.2** No pop-up error messages or “something went wrong” dialogs.
- ☐ **1.3** The library screen shows lots of books — small cover pictures, titles next to them. Roughly 60+ books visible (scroll up and down to confirm).
- ☐ **1.4** Book covers look right — actual artwork, not grey boxes with “No Image” or broken-image icons. A handful of grey ones across 60+ books is OK; a whole row is not.
- ☐ **1.5** Tap a category filter at the top (Fairytale, Animals, Numbers, etc.). The library narrows to just those books. Tap to clear; everything comes back.
- ☐ **1.6** Tap an age filter. Same idea — only books for that age range appear. Clear it and everything comes back.

2. Reading a simple book

Pick a short rhymebook to start with — something like Colors Rhymebook, Counting, or Alphabet. Tap it to open.

- ☐ **2.1** The book opens with a cover/title page. There’s a picture and a title.
- ☐ **2.2** You can hear a voice reading the title (if the voice is set to Human or Computer — see section 3).
- ☐ **2.3** Tap Next (or swipe to advance to the next page). Page 2 appears smoothly — image changes, text changes.
- ☐ **2.4** As the voice reads aloud, the word being spoken is highlighted on screen. Highlight moves left-to-right through the sentence in time with the voice. It should not jump around, freeze, or get stuck on the wrong word.
- ☐ **2.5** Read through to the end of the book (5–10 pages). Each page has its picture, its text, and its audio. No pages are missing.
- ☐ **2.6** When you reach the last page, tapping Next doesn’t crash the app or take you somewhere weird — it should either stay on the last page or politely return to the library.

3. Voice options

While reading a book, look for the three voice buttons (usually labeled or shown as icons for Human, Computer, and No Voice).

- ☐ **3.1** Pick Human. Audio is a real human narration; words are NOT highlighted (text just sits there).
- ☐ **3.2** Pick Computer. Audio is a computer-generated voice; words ARE highlighted as they’re spoken.
- ☐ **3.3** Pick No Voice. No audio plays; text sits there without highlighting. You can still page through.
- ☐ **3.4** Switching between the three takes effect on the next page (or immediately, depending on the book). No crashes, no stuck audio from the previous mode.

4. Reading a fairytale (longer book)

Pick a multi-page story like Cinderella, Red Riding Hood, or Three Little Pigs. These are longer and use more illustrations.

- ☐ 4.1 Opens cleanly, first page renders fully.
- ☐ 4.2 Audio narration matches the text on the page.
- ☐ 4.3 Page-turn animations don't tear or flash white.
- ☐ 4.4 Read past page 5. Picture and text update correctly for each new page.
- ☐ 4.5 Go back a page using Previous or swipe. Previous page restores correctly — same picture, same text, audio ready to replay.
- ☐ 4.6 Some books have multiple pictures per page (a small scrollable gallery). On those pages, swiping the picture should scroll the gallery, NOT turn the page. Once you reach the last image in the gallery, one more swipe should turn the page.

5. Auto-page

Look for an “Auto-page” or “Autoplay” toggle somewhere on the reading screen.

- ☐ 5.1 Turn it ON. Read a page. About half a second after the voice finishes the page, the app automatically advances to the next page.
- ☐ 5.2 Turn it OFF. Read a page. Audio finishes, the page stays — you have to tap Next manually.

6. Bookstore (if your build has one)

If the main screen has a “Bookstore” or “Shop” button, tap it.

- ☐ 6.1 Bookstore opens, shows books (might be the same library or a different selection).
- ☐ 6.2 Filters at the top work the same way as the library (genre, age range).
- ☐ 6.3 Tap a book. You should see a “Buy on Kindle” or “Buy Printed” type button. Before opening an external page, the app should ask you to solve a small math problem (the parental gate) — kids shouldn't be able to make purchases.
- ☐ 6.4 Solve the math problem. The app opens your phone's web browser to the Amazon / Kindle / print-store page for that book.
- ☐ 6.5 Tap your device's Back button (Android) or close the browser (iOS) to return to the app. The bookstore should still be where you left it, not crashed or stuck.

7. Settings

Find the Settings screen (usually a gear icon somewhere in the main UI).

- ☐ 7.1 Settings opens, shows controls — reading speed, voice preference, maybe sound effects.
- ☐ 7.2 Change the reading speed (slower or faster). Back out to the library, open a book — the new speed should be in effect.
- ☐ 7.3 Re-open Settings. Your speed choice is still selected (the setting persists across visits).

8. Books with animations and special effects

Some books have animations — characters that move, animals that flap their wings, things you can drag around. These are the newest parts of the app and we want to test them carefully.

If your build includes a special test book (it might be called TestBook or live under a “Test” category in QA builds), use that. If not, look for any book where things visibly move on a page beyond the static picture.

- ☐ **8.1** When the page opens, animated elements (characters, effects, flying insects, etc.) start moving on their own within a few seconds. They don’t appear as still frames or flashing white boxes.
- ☐ **8.2** Background videos (like underwater bubbles, swimming fish) play smoothly and loop — they shouldn’t skip, freeze, or stutter.
- ☐ **8.3** Tap an animated character that’s supposed to react to touch. It should respond — start playing, pause, or do its trick. Tap again to verify the response is consistent.
- ☐ **8.4** Drag a draggable element around the page. It moves with your finger. Letting go leaves it where you let go. Moving it doesn’t accidentally turn the page.
- ☐ **8.5** Some animated elements have sounds (a butterfly might laugh when tapped). Tap them and verify the sound plays. Tap rapidly several times — sounds should layer or repeat, not cut each other off.
- ☐ **8.6** Page away from the animation page (Next or swipe), then come back (Previous or swipe back). Animations restart cleanly — no leftover motion from before, no missing elements.

9. Offline behavior

This is the part where you’ll briefly turn off internet. Do this in a spot where you can comfortably turn it back on afterwards.

Step A — read a book first while online

- ☐ **9.1** With Wi-Fi on, open a book and read 3–4 pages. Make sure audio plays and pictures load. (This caches the content for offline use in the next steps.)

Step B — go offline and try the same book

Now turn off Wi-Fi AND cellular data (or put the device in airplane mode).

- ☐ **9.2** A small “no internet” notice may appear at the top or middle of the screen. That’s fine — it means the app noticed.
- ☐ **9.3** Go back into the same book you just read. The pages you already saw should still open, with pictures and audio. (The app caches recently-read content so kids can keep reading on a plane, in a basement, etc.)

Step C — try a book you haven’t opened yet

- ☐ **9.4** Try to open a different book you haven’t read this session. It might fail to load or show placeholder images — that’s acceptable (no internet, no new content). What we don’t want: app crash, app frozen, or a scary error message.

Step D — turn internet back on

- ☐ **9.5** Turn Wi-Fi (or cellular) back on. Within a few seconds, the “no internet” notice should disappear on its own. If there’s a “Try Again” button, tap it.
- ☐ **9.6** Open a book that didn’t load before. It should now load normally.

10. Memory and longevity

Use the app the way a kid would — go back and forth between many books over ~20 minutes.

- ☐ **10.1** Open 8–10 different books in sequence. Read a few pages of each, then back out. The app should stay responsive throughout — no slowdown, no crashes.
- ☐ **10.2** While in a book, fully close the app (swipe up from the app switcher on iOS, recent apps on Android). Reopen ReadingBuddy. The app should remember where you were.
- ☐ **10.3** Open the same book again. It should resume on the page you left off, not page 1.

11. Things you might notice that are NOT bugs

Save yourself the trouble of reporting these — they're either intentional or already known. They don't need to go in your findings list.

The book “The Strangest Machine in the World” has silent audio on page 1 at most speed settings. Known issue with the source audio, being re-recorded separately. Skip that page for testing.

A “loading” pause when first opening the library after install. About 10–20 seconds is normal on a fresh install — the app is downloading the book catalog. After the first time, it's fast.

Some books have version “v2” or “_v2” in their name and look almost identical to a non-v2 version. Both versions are intentional while we transition; this isn't a bug.

A brief internal notice about a “duplicate component” or “destroying” when entering certain rooms. Housekeeping; not user-visible most of the time and not worth reporting unless it causes a visible problem.

Animated butterflies sometimes give a brief jittery moment when you turn the page away from them. Known minor issue being addressed separately. Not blocking.

Older book covers may be lower resolution than newer ones. Art asset, not a bug.

12. The “weird things” sweep

Spend 5–10 minutes just exploring the app like a curious 6-year-old would. Try to break it.

- ☐ **12.1** Tap things rapidly. Double-tap, triple-tap buttons. Nothing should crash or get into a weird state.
- ☐ **12.2** Pinch and zoom on book pages. The app probably doesn't support zoom; that's fine. It shouldn't crash because you tried.
- ☐ **12.3** Rotate the device (if your build supports rotation). Layout should adapt without overlapping text or off-screen content.
- ☐ **12.4** Background the app for a minute (open another app, come back). ReadingBuddy resumes where you left it. Audio either stops on background and resumes on foreground, OR keeps playing — both are acceptable. What's not acceptable: crash, black screen, stuck.
- ☐ **12.5** Open a book, leave the app in the background for 5+ minutes, come back. Still works.

How to report problems

When you find something — anything — that's marked , please capture:

- What were you doing? (“I opened the book Cinderella and tapped Next to go to page 3.”)
- What did you expect to happen? (“Page 3 should appear with a new picture and the voice should read it.”)
- What actually happened? (“Page 3 picture loaded but the audio never started. After about 10 seconds I tapped Next again and it moved on.”)
- Could you repeat it? Try to reproduce the same problem 2 more times. Note: “happened every time” or “only happened once.”
- A screenshot if anything visual was wrong. On iOS: Side button + Volume Up. On Android: Power + Volume Down. The screenshot saves to your photos.
- Your device: model (iPad Air, Pixel 7, etc.) and OS version (iOS 17.2, Android 14) if you can find them in Settings.

Send everything as a single email or message — one item per problem, labeled “Issue 1”, “Issue 2”, etc. If you have a Windows PC, just copy the screenshots over and paste them into a Word document alongside your notes. Whatever's easiest.

When you're done

You're finished with this round when:

- You've worked through sections 1–7 (the standard reading experience) and most things are .
- You've worked through section 8 (animations) and at least poked at the books that have moving content.
- You've done the offline test (section 9) and the longevity sweep (sections 10 and 12).
- All  findings are written down in one place.

Send your notes and screenshots back. We'll triage them and decide which need fixing before the next build.

Thanks again for testing — kids using the app every day appreciate it even if they never know who you are.